

Walmart Sales Analysis Report

February 2010 - October 2012

45 Stores | 6,435 Records

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Executive Summary

This report analyzes Walmart's weekly sales data from February 2010 to October 2012, covering 45 stores and 6,435 sales records. The analysis identifies key sales patterns, measures holiday impact, evaluates store performance, and assesses economic factors influencing sales.

Key Findings:

- Total sales over the period: \$6.74 Billion
- Average weekly sales: \$1.05 Million per store
- Holiday weeks generate 7.8% higher sales
- December is the strongest month, January the weakest
- Store 20 outperforms Store 33 by 8.1x
- Sales declined 18.3% from 2011 to 2012

Key Performance Metrics

Metric	Value
Total Sales (All Time)	\$6.74 Billion
Average Weekly Sales	\$1.05 Million
Median Weekly Sales	\$0.96 Million
Maximum Weekly Sales	\$3.82 Million
Minimum Weekly Sales	\$0.21 Million
Total Stores Analyzed	45
Total Weeks Analyzed	143

Store Performance Analysis

Category	Store	Total Sales
Top Store	Store 20	\$301.4 Million
2nd Best Store	Store 4	\$299.5 Million
3rd Best Store	Store 14	\$289.0 Million
Bottom Store	Store 33	\$37.2 Million

2nd Worst Store	Store 44	\$43.3 Million
3rd Worst Store	Store 5	\$45.5 Million
Sales Gap (Best vs Worst)	8.1x	
Top 5 Stores Contribution	21.5%	
Top 10 Stores Contribution	39.1%	

Insight: Store performance varies dramatically. The top 5 stores generate over one-fifth of total sales, while the bottom 5 stores underperform significantly. Stores 14, 10, and 20 show high sales volatility, while Stores 33, 30, and 37 are consistently low.

Holiday Impact Analysis

Metric	Value	Note
Holiday Weeks	450	7.0% of total weeks
Non-Holiday Weeks	5,985	93.0% of total weeks
Avg Sales - Holiday Weeks	\$1,122,888	+7.8% lift
Avg Sales - Non-Holiday	\$1,041,256	Baseline
Best Holiday Week	Nov 25, 2011	Store 4: \$3.0M
Highest Holiday Lift Store	Store 7	+19.4%
Lowest Holiday Lift Store	Store 30	-0.4%

Insight: Despite representing only 7% of weeks, holiday periods deliver significantly higher sales. However, not all stores benefit equally - Stores 7, 35, and 15 show exceptional holiday performance (+14% to +19%), while Stores 30, 38, and 36 show negative or minimal lift.

Seasonal Patterns

Category	Period	Average Sales
Best Month	December	\$1,281,864 avg weekly
Worst Month	January	\$923,885 avg weekly

Month Difference	December vs January	+38.7%
Best Season	Winter	\$1,094,937 avg weekly
Worst Season	Spring	\$1,023,801 avg weekly
Q4 vs Q1	Oct-Dec vs Jan-Mar	+12.2%

Insight: Sales follow a clear seasonal pattern with a strong Q4 peak driven by holiday shopping. Sales decline sharply in January (post-holiday slowdown) and remain moderate through spring and summer. Winter season shows the highest overall average.

Economic Factor Correlations

Factor	Correlation	Strength	Direction
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Unemployment	-0.106	Weak	Negative
CPI	-0.073	Very Weak	Negative
Temperature	-0.064	Very Weak	Negative
Fuel Price	+0.009	Very Weak	Positive

Insight: External economic factors show very weak correlation with sales. Temperature, fuel prices, and CPI have minimal predictive value. Unemployment shows the strongest (but still weak) negative correlation. Seasonal and holiday factors are more reliable sales drivers.

Year-over-Year Trends

Year	Total Sales	Growth Rate
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2010	\$2,288.9 Million	Baseline
2011	\$2,448.2 Million	+7.0%
2012	\$2,000.1 Million	-18.3%

Insight: Sales grew 7.0% from 2010 to 2011 but declined sharply by 18.3% in 2012. This significant decline requires immediate investigation into potential causes including competitive pressures, pricing changes, or external market factors.

Recommendations

SHORT-TERM ACTIONS (Next Quarter):

1. Investigate 2012 Sales Decline
 - Conduct store-level audits for declining locations
 - Review pricing, promotions, and competitive positioning
 - Priority: High | Expected Impact: Root cause identification
2. Analyze Underperforming Stores
 - Focus on Stores 33, 44, 5, 36, 38
 - Identify operational or market-specific issues
 - Priority: High | Expected Impact: Revenue recovery
3. Implement Holiday Best Practices
 - Study and replicate strategies from Stores 7, 35, 15
 - Apply successful tactics to low-lift stores
 - Priority: Medium | Expected Impact: Increased holiday lift

LONG-TERM STRATEGIES (Next 12 Months):

1. Optimize Seasonal Operations
 - Ramp up staffing and inventory from September through December
 - Plan post-holiday clearance for January
 - Align marketing campaigns with monthly sales patterns
2. Maximize Holiday Opportunities
 - Concentrate marketing spend on the 7% of weeks that drive premium sales
 - Pre-holiday inventory build-up starting September
 - Develop store-specific holiday strategies
3. Replicate Top-Store Success
 - Study best practices from Stores 20, 4, 14, 13, 2
 - Create performance improvement plans for bottom 5 stores
 - Establish store-to-store mentorship programs

Conclusions

WHAT WORKS:

- Holiday promotions deliver +7.8% sales lift
- December peak season drives maximum revenue
- Top stores demonstrate replicable success models

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION:

- 18.3% sales decline from 2011 to 2012 requires investigation
- 8.1x performance gap between best and worst stores
- Post-holiday drop significantly impacts Q1 performance

WHAT DOESN'T MATTER MUCH:

- Temperature has virtually no impact on sales
- Fuel prices show minimal correlation
- CPI provides weak predictive value

FINAL TAKEAWAY:

Walmart's sales are driven primarily by seasonal timing and holiday events, not by broad economic factors. The performance gap between stores and the 2012 decline represent the biggest opportunities for intervention. Success lies in replicating top-store practices, maximizing the limited holiday window, and investigating the causes of the 2012 downturn.

Appendix: Data Summary

Analysis Dataset Information:

- Source: Walmart Sales Forecasting Dataset
- Time Period: February 2010 - October 2012
- Total Records: 6,435 weekly sales records
- Stores Analyzed: 45 stores

Data Quality Summary:

- Missing Values: 0
- Duplicate Records: 0
- Negative Sales Values: 0
- Outlier Records Identified: 34

Key Columns:

- Store - Store number (1-45)
- Date - Week of sales
- Weekly_Sales - Sales for that week
- Holiday_Flag - 1 = Holiday week, 0 = Non-holiday
- Temperature - Temperature on sale day
- Fuel_Price - Regional fuel cost
- CPI - Consumer Price Index
- Unemployment - Regional unemployment rate